INCH-POUND

A-A-20234
May 22, 1995

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

WAFFLES, SHELF STABLE

The U.S. Department of Agriculture has authorized the use of this commercial item description as a replacement for MIL-W-44480 by all Federal agencies.

1. SCOPE.

1.1 This Commercial Item Description (CID) covers shelf stable (water activity stabilized) waffles, packed in flexible pouches, suitable for use by the Federal Government and as a component of operational rations.

2. CLASSIFICATION.

2.1 The shelf stable waffles shall conform to the types in the following list which shall be specified in the solicitation, contract, or purchase order.

Types.

Type I - Waffle, plain
Type II - Waffle, berry flavored with added blueberries

3. SALIENT CHARACTERISTICS.

3.1 Processing: The shelf stable waffles shall be prepared in accordance with good commercial practice.

Beneficial comments, recommendations, additions, deletions, clarifications, etc., and any data which may improve this document should be sent to: Commander, U.S. Army Soldier Systems Command, Natick Research, Development, and Engineering Center, ATTN: SSCNC-WRE, Natick, MA 01760-5018.

FSC 8920

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3.2 Ingredients: The shelf stable waffles shall include flour, sugar, eggs, vegetable oil, salt, vanilla flavoring, leavening agents such as baking powder, and may contain emulsifiers or other stabilizing ingredients such as lecithin, xanthan gum or glycerol, and other ingredients. Type II waffles shall also include blueberries averaging five percent by weight of the waffle and berry flavoring. All egg ingredients shall comply with all applicable provisions of Egg Products Inspection Act and the regulations promulgated thereunder (7 CFR Part 59) and shall be certified salmonella free.

3.3 Finished product: The finished shelf stable waffle shall be a fully baked, light to medium golden-brown waffle with maximum dimensions of 3-1/2 inches by 2-3/4 inches by 7/8 inch. The shelf stable waffles shall show no evidence of excessive heating (materially darkened or scorched), shall not be excessively crumbly, dry, and/or crisp, shall not have gummy centers or soggy areas, and shall have no raw portions.

3.3.1 Appearance: The shelf stable waffles shall have a light to medium golden-brown exterior and an off white to tan interior. The Type II waffles shall also have the addition of small blueberries dispersed throughout the surface and interior of the waffles. There shall be no color foreign to the product.

3.3.2 Odor and flavor: The shelf stable waffles shall have a predominantly sweet flavor complimented by mild egg and vanilla flavors and a sweet odor with no evidence of oxidation, rancidity, or staling. The Type II waffles shall also have a blueberry flavor and a sweet blueberry odor. There shall be no foreign odors or flavors such as, but not limited to, burnt, scorched, musty, or moldy.

3.3.3 Texture: The waffles shall be moist and tender, not dry or rubbery. The Type II waffles shall have small, soft, moist blueberries.

3.3.4 Foreign material: All ingredients shall be clean, sound, wholesome, and free from evidence of rodent or insect infestation. There shall be no foreign material, such as, but limited to, dirt, insect parts, hair, wood, glass, or metal.

3.3.5 Net weight: Each pouch shall contain not less than 12 ounces (340.19 g) of product.

3.3.6 Water activity: The water activity (Aw) for the product in any individual pouch shall be 0.650 to 0.850.

3.4 Pouch filling and sealing: Each pouch shall be filled with 18 waffles which conform to finished product and analytical requirements, on a food grade paperboard tray, and a sufficient number of oxygen absorbers to assure that the oxygen content in the filled and sealed pouch does not exceed 0.2 percent. The oxygen absorber substance shall be Food and Drug Administration

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(FDA) approved as suitable for use with food and the package material shall be FDA approved for direct contact with food and shall be resistant to the absorption of oil and moisture.

3.5 Analytical requirements:

3.5.1 Water activity testing: Eight filled and sealed pouches shall be selected at random from the lot regardless of lot size and shall be individually tested for Aw in accordance with the Official Methods of Analysis of the AOAC International. Aw testing shall take place in an Agricultural Marketing Service laboratory not less than four days but not more than fourteen days after packaging to allow moisture equilibration in the product. The sample unit shall be one waffle selected from the center of any stack in the pouch. Aw shall be determined from the center of the sample unit. The results of each Aw determination shall be reported to the third decimal place. Any result not conforming to the finished product requirement for Aw shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

3.5.2 Oxygen testing: Eight filled and sealed pouches shall be selected at random from the lot regardless of lot size and shall be individually tested for oxygen content not less than 36 hours after sealing. Results shall be reported to the nearest 0.1 percent. Any result not conforming to the requirement for oxygen content shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

Test	Method Number/Test
Aw	978.18
Oxygen	1/

1/ **Oxygen content test**. Each filled and sealed pouch shall be tested for oxygen by using an electronic, oxygen analyzer which operates on the principle of the difference in partial pressure of oxygen reference and oxygen content of the sample as detected by a porous ceramic Zirconia Sensor, such as the Illinois Instruments or Mocon Analyzers, or their equivalent; or on the principle of paramagnetic resonance such as the Servomex analyzer, or equivalent. The oxygen analyzer shall be calibrated to a known standard value prior to testing product.

4. REGULATORY REQUIREMENTS.

4.1 The delivered shelf stable waffles shall comply with all applicable Federal and State mandatory requirements and regulations relating to the preparation, packaging, labeling, storage, distribution, and sale of the shelf stable waffles within the commercial marketplace. Delivered shelf stable waffles shall comply with all applicable provisions of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and regulations promulgated thereunder.

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5. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS.

5.1 Contractor's certification. The contractor shall certify and maintain substantiating evidence that the shelf stable waffles offered meets the salient characteristics of this CID, and that the shelf stable waffles conforms to the producer's own drawings, specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices, and are the same shelf stable waffles offered for sale in the commercial marketplace. The Government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to first delivery and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.

5.2 Quality assurance. When required in the solicitation, contract, or purchase order that product quality or acceptability or both be determined, the Processed Products Branch, Fruit and Vegetable Division, Agricultural Marketing Service, U.S. Department of Agriculture, shall be the certifying activity. The shelf stable waffles shall be examined or analyzed or both in accordance with applicable provisions in this CID, solicitation, contract, or purchase order, and, when applicable, the United States Standards for Condition of Food Containers in effect on the date of the solicitation.

6. PACKAGING.

6.1 Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and case marking. Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and case marking shall be as specified in the solicitation, contract, or purchase order.

7. NOTES.

7.1 Purchasers shall specify:

- Type of waffle.

7.2 Sources of documents.

7.2.1 Source of information for nongovernmental documents is as follows:

Copies of the Official Methods of Analysis of the AOAC International may be obtained from: **AOAC International, 2200 Wilson Boulevard, Suite 400, Arlington, VA 22201-3301**.

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7.2.2 Sources of information for governmental documents are as follows:

Applicable provisions of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act are contained in 21 CFR Parts 1 to 199. This three-volume set may be purchased from: **Superintendent of Documents, ATTN: New Orders, P.O. Box 371954, Pittsburgh, PA 15250-7954.** Credit card (MasterCard or Visa) purchases may be made by calling the Superintendent of Documents on (202) 512-1800.

Copies of the United States Standards for Condition of Food Containers are available from: **Chairperson, Condition of Container Committee, Agricultural Marketing Service, U.S. Department of Agriculture, Room 2506, South Building, P.O. Box 96456, Washington, DC 20090-6456.**

Copies of Inspection of Egg and Egg Products (Egg Products Inspection Act), (7 CFR Part 59), may be obtained from: **Standardization Branch, Poultry Division, Agricultural Marketing Service, U.S. Department of Agriculture, Room 3944, South Building, P.O. Box 96456, Washington, DC 20090-6456.**

Civil agencies and other interested parties may obtain copies of this CID from: **General Services Administration, Federal Supply Service Bureau, Specifications Section, Suite 8100, 470 L'Enfant Plaza, SW, Washington, DC 20407.**

Military activities should submit requests for copies of this CID to: **Standardization Documents Order Desk, Building 4, Section D, 700 Robbins Avenue, Philadelphia, PA 19111-5094.**

MILITARY INTERESTS:

Custodians

Army - GL
Navy - SA
Air Force - 35

Review Activities

Army - MD, QM
Navy - MC
DLA - SS

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITIES:

DOJ - BOP
HHS - NIH, IHS
USDA - FV
VA - OSS

PREPARING ACTIVITY:

Army - GL

Project No. 8920-0568

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